

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 2

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1. Adulterate

Meaning: To make something impure by adding inferior or harmful substances.

Tip to remember: Think of “adding dirt” to something pure. If milk is mixed with water, it is adulterated.

Sentence: The company was punished for adulterating food products.

2. Advocate

Meaning: To support or argue in favor of something; also, a supporter.

Tip to remember: Think of a lawyer advocating for a client in court.

Sentence: She advocates the use of renewable energy.

3. Aggrandize

Meaning: To increase the power, wealth, status, or importance of something.

Tip to remember: “Grand” means big. Aggrandize means to make something grand or bigger.

Sentence: The ruler tried to aggrandize his empire through war.

4. Alacrity

Meaning: Cheerful eagerness or readiness.

Tip to remember: Think of a student who says “Yes, I will do it!” immediately and happily. That is alacrity.

Sentence: He accepted the internship offer with alacrity.

5. Ambivalent

Meaning: Having mixed or opposite feelings about something.

Tip to remember: “Ambi” means both. Ambivalent means feeling both yes and no.

Sentence: She was ambivalent about moving abroad for study.

6. Ameliorate

Meaning: To improve or make something better.

Tip to remember: Think of “a meal I ate” making your mood better. Ameliorate means improve.

Sentence: The new policy helped ameliorate the living conditions of workers.

7. Amenable

Meaning: Willing to agree, cooperate, or be influenced.

Tip to remember: Amenable sounds like “amen.” If someone says amen, they agree.
Sentence: The professor was amenable to extending the deadline.

8. **Anachronistic**

Meaning: Belonging to a different time period; outdated or historically misplaced.

Tip to remember: “Chron” means time. Anachronistic means something is in the wrong time.

Sentence: A sword in a modern science-fiction movie may look anachronistic.

9. **Audacious**

Meaning: Bold, daring, or fearless, sometimes in a rude way.

Tip to remember: Think of someone who dares to ask a very risky question in public. That person is audacious.

Sentence: His audacious plan surprised everyone.

10. **Avaricious**

Meaning: Extremely greedy for money or possessions.

Tip to remember: Think of a person who always wants “a very rich” life. Avaricious means greedy.

Sentence: The avaricious businessman cared only about profit.

11. **Banal**

Meaning: Boring because it is ordinary or unoriginal.

Tip to remember: Banal sounds like “ban all.” You want to ban all boring ideas.

Sentence: The speech was filled with banal comments.

12. **Benign**

Meaning: Gentle, kind, or harmless.

Tip to remember: In medicine, a benign tumor is not dangerous. So benign means harmless.

Sentence: The old man gave the child a benign smile.

13. **Brazen**

Meaning: Shamelessly bold; showing no embarrassment.

Tip to remember: Think of someone lying openly even after being caught. That is brazen.

Sentence: The thief made a brazen attempt to steal in daylight.

14. **Calumny**

Meaning: A false statement made to damage someone’s reputation.

Tip to remember: Calumny sounds like “call me names.” It means spreading harmful lies.

Sentence: The politician was hurt by the calumny spread by his rivals.

15. **Candid**

Meaning: Honest, direct, and truthful.

Tip to remember: Think of a candid photo: natural and not fake. Candid speech is

also not fake.

Sentence: She gave a candid opinion about the project.

16. **Castigate**

Meaning: To criticize or scold someone severely.

Tip to remember: Think of a teacher casting harsh words at a student for cheating.

Sentence: The coach castigated the players for their poor discipline.

17. **Caustic**

Meaning: Harsh, biting, or sarcastic; able to burn chemically.

Tip to remember: Caustic soda can burn skin. Caustic words can also burn emotionally.

Sentence: His caustic remarks offended many people.

18. **Construe**

Meaning: To interpret or understand something in a particular way.

Tip to remember: Think of “constructing meaning.” When you construe something, you build its meaning.

Sentence: His silence was construed as agreement.

19. **Contrite**

Meaning: Feeling very sorry for doing something wrong.

Tip to remember: Contrite sounds like “can’t write” because you feel so guilty that you cannot even write an apology.

Sentence: The student was contrite after cheating on the exam.

20. **Convolutd**

Meaning: Very complicated and difficult to understand.

Tip to remember: Think of a twisted wire. A convoluted explanation is twisted and confusing.

Sentence: The professor’s convoluted explanation confused the class.

21. **Covet**

Meaning: To strongly desire something that belongs to someone else.

Tip to remember: Think of “cover it because I want it.” If you covet something, you badly want it.

Sentence: Many students covet admission to top universities.

22. **Craven**

Meaning: Cowardly; lacking courage.

Tip to remember: Craven sounds like “craving safety.” A craven person always chooses safety because of fear.

Sentence: His craven refusal to speak the truth disappointed everyone.

23. **Decorum**

Meaning: Proper and polite behavior.

Tip to remember: Think of “decorating” your behavior properly in formal situations.

Sentence: Students are expected to maintain decorum during the ceremony.

24. **Deft**
Meaning: Skillful and quick in movement or action.
Tip to remember: Think of a deft electrician quickly fixing wires with skilled hands.
Sentence: The surgeon made a deft movement with the instrument.
25. **Demur**
Meaning: To object or show hesitation.
Tip to remember: Demur sounds like “the murmur.” A person may murmur softly when objecting.
Sentence: She accepted the proposal without demur.
26. **Derivative**
Meaning: Not original; copied or developed from something else.
Tip to remember: In math, a derivative comes from another function. In vocabulary, derivative means coming from another source.
Sentence: The movie was criticized for being derivative.
27. **Desiccate**
Meaning: To dry out completely.
Tip to remember: Think of dried fruits. They are desiccated because water has been removed.
Sentence: The hot sun desiccated the soil.
28. **Diatribes**
Meaning: A long, angry speech or criticism.
Tip to remember: Think of someone giving a long angry “tribe speech” against another group.
Sentence: The manager launched into a diatribe about laziness.
29. **Incredulous**
Meaning: Unable or unwilling to believe something.
Tip to remember: “In” means not, and “cred” means believe. Incredulous means not believing.
Sentence: He was incredulous when he heard that he had won the prize.
30. **Ingenuous**
Meaning: Innocent, honest, and straightforward; sometimes naively simple.
Tip to remember: Ingenuous sounds like genuine. An ingenuous person is genuinely innocent and honest.
Sentence: Her ingenuous answer impressed the interviewers.